You can run this example from the command line by entering the following in the root of the Git repository:

```
$ sbt "chapter11a/runMain example.http.HttpServer"
```

Once the server is running, you can call it with a `curl` command:

```
$ curl localhost:8080/ping
pong
```

11.1.3 Directives

You can use directives to create paths and routes, extract data from the request, create exceptions, and more. Directives provide a DSL that offers a variety of ways to create all kinds of routes with very concise expressions. The generic usage of a directive is as follows:

```
directiveName(arguments) { extractions =>    ❶
  ... // inner route
}
```

❶ Extraction is optional.

In general, directives can do the following:

- Transform the request and pass it to the inner route.
- Filter the request to exclude some of the inner routes.
- Extract values from the request with, for example, `parameters` or `extractUri`.
- Intercept an intermediate result and modify it with `handle`, `failWith`, and `reject`.